



**Soil Food Web
Foundation**

A 501(c)(3) nonprofit



Soil crumbled by hand at the edge of a planted field.

The ground beneath our farms and forests is alive.

A web of bacteria, fungi, protozoa, nematodes and micro-arthropods feeds plants, builds soil, stores carbon and cleans water when it is intact.

The Soil Food Web Foundation teaches people to see that web, restore it, and publish what happens when they do. It is a nonprofit and a school working together: education, open research, applied practice, and a global community, all pointed at the same problem. Living soil is the solution, and it is beneath your feet.



EDUCATION



RESEARCH



PRACTICE



COMMUNITY

100+

Countries in our student and practitioner community

10,000+

Individuals enrolled in our programs

40

Years of pioneering soil biology research behind the method

Healing soil.
Feeding humanity.
Restoring the living world.

OUR STORY

It began with one scientist looking closer.



Dr. Elaine Ingham at the microscope.

Dr. Elaine Ingham pioneered research in soil biology across four decades and made her science radically accessible, so that anyone anywhere could learn to restore the soil beneath their feet.

The Foundation was created in 2025 to carry that work forward. Dr. Ingham died in February 2026. The work continues through the Foundation and the school inside it, and practitioners in more than 100 countries carry the same close attention into their own soil.

She taught at Oregon State from 1986 to 2002, was the first President of the Soil Ecology Society, and co-authored the USDA's Soil Biology Primer. Her full record is on Google Scholar: scholar.google.com/citations?user=iOm3z4AAAAAJ



Dr. Ingham pouring a sample through a filter, students watching.



WHY THIS MATTERS FOR CLIMATE

Plants pull carbon from the air and invest much of it in the soil, where it is built into microbial bodies, aggregates and long-lived fungal networks. Biological management also avoids emissions: less fertilizer manufactured and moved, fewer passes over the field.



Watch a free webinar

A live hour with an instructor or a practitioner, every month. The easiest first step.

sfw.one/brochure-webinar

TEACHING

Anyone, anywhere, can learn to restore living soil.



A mentor teaching on working land.

From a first curiosity through to professional practice. Everyone starts with the Foundation Courses. Where you go next depends on whether you want to grow better yourself, or help other people do it.



Foundation Courses

The science of the soil food web, the organisms and their roles, and how biological amendments are made and applied. Online, self-paced, about 150 hours, and required before any Advanced Program.



Advanced Programs

Soil Microscopy, BioComplete™ Compost Production, Biological Liquid Amendments and Field Trial, each with its own mentor. All four together are the Complete Practicum.



Accelerator Workshops

The Advanced Programs worked through as a group on working land, the whole method applied at once. Held periodically, and hosted with a partner on their own ground. Dates and places are listed with the programs.



Where it leads

The Complete Practicum carries the Soil Food Web Consultant title; Soil Microscopy alone, the Lab Technician title. Every program, with its price, is listed at school.soilfoodweb.com



Apply for a scholarship

Scholarships prioritize applicants in under-resourced regions.

sfw.one/brochure-scholarship